

Talent and Prosperity for All

*Washington's Operational and Program-Specific
Workforce Plan Components*

TANF State Plan Components

August 1, 2026



Washington State
Workforce Training
And Education
Coordinating Board

Washington State Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) State Plan

States that include TANF in the Combined State Plan must outline how the State will meet the requirements of section 402 of the Social Security Act including the following information.

(a) Conduct a program designed to serve all political subdivisions in the State (not necessarily in a uniform manner) that provides assistance to needy families with (or expecting) children and provides parents with job preparation, work, and support services to enable them to leave the program, specifically cash assistance, and become self-sufficient (section 402(a)(1)(A)(i) of the Social Security Act).

On November 1, 1997, Washington's WorkFirst Program became operational statewide. The program was designed to move families on welfare into employment as quickly as possible through upfront job search, work experience activities, and short-term education and training.

Today the program is an integral part of a statewide effort to [reduce poverty](#) in Washington. It aims to connect families to resources and opportunities with the overall goal of reducing poverty in a way that eliminates disparities. The State has instituted, by rule, uniform program policies in all political subdivisions, including uniform TANF cash benefit standards.

Washington State provides cash benefits to all needy families who meet the eligibility criteria established by rules of the Department of Social and Health Services (DSHS) and in accordance with this State Plan. TANF is the major cash assistance program providing cash benefits for low-income families with (or expecting) children in Washington State. The WorkFirst program offers services and activities to help program participants find and maintain paid, unsubsidized employment and improve wages over time, with the vision of supporting pathways towards economic stability and mobility. The WorkFirst program links families to a variety of state, federal, and community resources. Examples include:

- Child support collection.
- Food assistance.
- Subsidized child care.
- Medical assistance.
- Tuition assistance at community and technical colleges.
- Employment related services.
- WorkFirst support services.

WorkFirst support services include assistance with paying for work clothing/tools, car repair, driver's and vehicle licensing, diapers, hygiene supplies and transportation. Job preparation services also include education and training tuition assistance, books, test fees and subsidized work experience. In addition, the program is dedicated to assisting families in working towards continued economic stability and mobility once they become employed by providing employment retention and wage progression services.

In operating the WorkFirst Program, Washington State:

- Provides an up-front employability screening and assessment for participants prior to any activity assignment to assess work readiness and barriers to employment. Washington elects by

state option allowed per 45 CFR 261.11(b) to apply a 90-day assessment deadline; however, the goal is to complete assessments within 30 days of eligibility determination.

- Requires participation in job search activities for work-ready individuals.
- Assigns participants who need additional support, skills, or work experience and/or those who do not find work in a job search activity, to paid work experience, subsidized employment, other work-like activities, or barrier removal activities as determined appropriate by assessment. Additional job search activities may also be assigned for a short length of time in these circumstances.
- Provides employment services to help participants remain employed and to progress in skills and wages.
- Provides educational opportunities, both in classroom settings and on the worksite.
- Encourages continued alliance of state, local, and tribal government, business, faith-based organizations, nonprofit organizations, and individuals, who dedicate themselves to helping families in poverty overcome barriers (RCW 74.08A.280(2)).

As the WorkFirst program has evolved, more emphasis has been placed on supporting families in overcoming barriers to employment, job retention, and reducing cycling on and off assistance.

(b) Require a parent or caretaker receiving assistance to engage in work (defined by the State) once the State determines the parent or caretaker is ready to engage in work, or once they have received 24 months of assistance, whichever is earlier, consistent with the child care exception at 407(e)(2) (section 402(a)(1)(A)(ii) of the Social Security Act.

Washington State defines work activity to include:

- Unsubsidized paid employment.
- Subsidized paid employment.
- Work experience.
- On-the-job training.
- Job search and job readiness assistance.
- Life skills training.
- Community service.
- Vocational education including internships and practicums.
- Job skills training related to employment.
- Education related to employment for a parent who has not completed high school or equivalent.
- Volunteering in a child's licensed child care, pre-school or elementary school.
- Participation in post-employment activities to the extent federally countable.
- Participation in other services to become employable to the extent federally countable such as:
 - Mental health services.
 - Family violence services.
 - Substance use disorder services.

What criteria will Washington State use to determine whether a parent or caretaker relative is ready to engage in work before 24 months?

Washington State requires all WorkFirst participants to undergo an evaluation/screening to determine the most appropriate activities for initial engagement. Participants may enter a job search activity if the evaluation finds them “work-ready” based on current or recent work experience.

What criteria has the State established relative to a single custodial parent’s “demonstrated inability” to obtain needed child care?

Washington State recognizes that informed choice is consistent with individual responsibility and that parents should be given a range of options for available child care while participating in the WorkFirst program.

Criteria established for “demonstrated inability” to obtain needed child care include when child care:

- Is not affordable - *costs more than the co-payment would be under the state’s primary subsidized child care program, Working Connections Child Care (WCCC).*
- Is not appropriate - *not licensed, certified or approved under federal, state, or tribal law and regulations for the type of care used or there is no appropriate and approved relative or in-home provider available.*
- Does not meet the level of care required for a child with special medical or behavioral health needs.
- Is not within a reasonable distance - *within reach without traveling farther than is normally expected in the community.*

(c) Ensure that parents and caretakers receiving assistance engage in work in accordance with section 407 (section 402(a)(1)(A)(iii) of the Social Security Act). Consistent with the required strategic elements discussed in section II (a)(2) herein, provide a specific analysis of how the State’s workforce development activities are addressing employment and training services for parents or caretakers receiving assistance.

Washington has established program goals focused on exits to employment and wage progression. Our expectation is that low-income families who are part of WorkFirst are supported and provided with resources and services that can lead to obtaining employment and improved economic stability. To the degree possible, all low-income families will have access to services that help them gain work skills and earn enough income to become economically stable. Our State uses various welfare-to-work models, including models focused on moving job-ready participants into work, and providing employment-related training that is expected to lead directly to work for those in need of additional skills.

While DSHS is the single State agency responsible for administering the TANF program, six core state agencies work together to manage the WorkFirst program. These agencies, referred to as the WorkFirst Partnership, include:

- Office of Financial Management (OFM).
- Department of Commerce (Commerce).
- Employment Security Department (ESD).
- Department of Social and Health Services (DSHS).

- Washington State Board for Community and Technical Colleges (SBCTC).
- Department of Children, Youth & Families (DCYF).

The WorkFirst Partnership drives collaboration and innovation across agencies, with direction coming from agency leadership, the Washington state Legislature, as well as a task force comprised of Washington Legislative and Executive agency leadership – known as the *Legislative-Executive WorkFirst Poverty Reduction Oversight Task Force*.

ESD provides labor exchange (Wagner-Peyser) services for WorkFirst participants. Community and technical colleges provide a variety of vocational education and subsidized work experience options. Commerce provides subsidized jobs and unpaid work experience opportunities for participants with barriers to employment. DCYF operates a subsidized child care program for low-income working families including those participating in WorkFirst and Basic Food Employment and Training (BFET). DCYF also manages the state-funded pre-kindergarten program, a home visiting system and other family strengthening services for low-income, at-risk, pregnant, or parenting families, including those receiving TANF. DSHS's Division of Vocational Rehabilitation (DVR) serves WorkFirst participants who qualify for their services. Post-TANF families may also be eligible for services through Washington's BFET program up to its eligibility threshold of 200% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL).

In the TANF program, the education and training options for parents are directed by state policies captured in state statute and rule and subsequent process rules which may be federally or state driven that don't apply to the Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act (WIOA) core programs. This includes the 12-month limit on federally countable stand-alone vocational education and the 30% cap for vocational education participation. On the other hand, strengths of the TANF funding stream include the ability to provide tuition assistance and child care for parents engaged in approved education and training activities.

Historically, previous to WIOA, the one-stop workforce development system in Washington State did not prioritize providing services to individuals with the range of barriers to employment identified in WIOA, who can be found in disproportionate numbers on the TANF caseload. With the expanded number of partners represented in this Combined State Plan, and the efficiencies that go with improved coordination, Washington State seeks to improve its capacity to serve these disadvantaged populations. This will be accomplished through intentional work at both the local and state levels and through the articulation of partnerships, services and strategies within Memoranda of Understandings, and local plans.

(d) Take such reasonable steps as the State deems necessary to restrict the use and disclosure of information about individuals and families receiving assistance under the program attributable to funds provided by the Federal Government (section 402(a)(1)(A)(iv) of the Social Security Act).

Washington has established confidentiality rules and procedures within the guidelines provided under state (RCW 74.04.060, 74.04.062) and federal law. The following changes have been made in response to state and federal welfare reform legislation.

Washington has revised confidentiality provisions that expand access to customer records by law enforcement officials. Specifically, in accordance with the Social Security Act, the DSHS will disclose the

current address and location of a WorkFirst recipient to an officer of the law or a person identified as a United States immigration official if DSHS is given the recipient's name and social security number and the officer/official satisfactorily demonstrates that the recipient is a fugitive, that the location or apprehension of the recipient is within the officer's/official's duties, and that the request is made in the proper exercise of those duties. In addition, if DSHS becomes aware that a WorkFirst recipient is the subject of an outstanding warrant that meets certain criteria, DSHS may contact the appropriate law enforcement agency and, if the warrant is valid, provide the law enforcement agency with the location of the recipient.

DSHS provides the Employment Security Department with the names and social security numbers of all recipients in the WorkFirst program. This information is used for the purposes of statistical analysis and evaluation of the WorkFirst program only.

Attachment A [of the TANF State Plan] is written certification by Governor Bob Ferguson that during the federal fiscal year the State will:

- Establish and enforce standards and procedures to ensure that the State screens for and identifies WorkFirst participants with a history of family violence as defined under Social Security Act (while maintaining confidentiality).
- Refer such individuals to counseling and supportive services and waive some requirements, such as time limit, work participation, and child support cooperation, in cases where compliance with such requirements would make it more difficult to escape family violence or unfairly penalize program participants.

(e) Establish goals and take action to prevent and reduce out-of-wedlock pregnancies, with special emphasis on teenage pregnancies (section 402(a)(1)(A)(v) of the Social Security Act).

Following welfare reform legislation of the late '90s, the director of Washington's Office of Financial Management established an interagency task force on unintended pregnancy to review existing research on the short and long-range costs, analyze the impact on the WorkFirst program, and implement a state strategy to reduce out-of-wedlock and unintended pregnancy.

DSHS, Health Care Authority, Department of Health, Office of the Superintendent of Public Instruction and other state agencies established goals associated with this task force and have continued to take action to prevent and reduce the incidence of out-of-wedlock pregnancies, with special emphasis on teenage pregnancies. The focus is to decrease unintended pregnancy, empower families to choose if and when they have children, and increase access and decrease barriers to quality family planning services.

Through a federal waiver, called TAKE CHARGE, the State provides pre-pregnancy family planning services to citizen men and women with family incomes up to and including 260% of the Federal Poverty Level (FPL). The State also extends eligibility for family planning services to citizen women up to 260% of the FPL for a year after their pregnancy ends. Non-citizen women with Medicaid coverage for the birth of a child receive state-funded family planning services for one year after the end of their pregnancy. These women are NOT eligible for family planning services under the federally approved family planning waiver. Non-Medicaid, low-income men and women can also receive family planning services through Department of Health Title X-funded family planning clinics.

Additional programs that contribute to achieving goals for preventing and reducing out-of-wedlock pregnancy include:

- The Washington College Grant and College Bound Scholarship programs for low-income students wishing to pursue higher education.
- The Early Childhood Education Assistance Program serving low-income 3- and 4-year-old children.
- The Promoting Academic Success and Learning Assistance Programs for low-income and high-risk public-school students.
- The full-day kindergarten for all schools and reduced class size programs in high-poverty elementary schools.

All of these programs affect long-term outcomes including reduced likelihood of contact with the criminal justice system, higher earnings as adults, less reliance on social services as adults and fewer out-of-wedlock pregnancies.

(f) Conduct a program designed to reach State and local law enforcement officials, the education system, and relevant counseling services, that provides education and training on the problem of statutory rape so that teenage pregnancy prevention programs may be expanded to include men (section 402(a)(1)(A)(vi) of the Social Security Act).

Washington State conducts a program reaching a variety of stakeholders and partners to educate and train on the problem of statutory rape. Specific examples are highlighted below.

Please note, crimes that may be considered statutory rape in other states, are considered ‘rape of a child’ under Washington statute. This distinction was deliberate to underscore that adolescents and teens under particular ages are not able to consent to sexual acts.

In conjunction with the Washington State Association of Prosecuting Attorneys (WAPA), through the WAPA/State Judicial Case Processing Task Force, Washington State has developed mandatory reporting protocol for child support cases meeting the criteria for rape of a child. TANF and other public assistance program staff receive detailed direction on how to report suspected rape of a child to law enforcement. In addition, pursuant to the Social Security Act, minor parents’ or pregnant minors’ living situation cannot include an adult parent of the qualifying child if that parent is convicted of rape of a child (RCW 9A.44.079).

Washington State also has a robust sexual and domestic violence prevention approach, with the Washington Coalition Against Domestic Violence (WSCADV) & Washington Coalition of Sexual Assault Programs (WCSAP) being national leaders in prevention. DSHS contracts with WSCADV to provide resources and training efforts dedicated to the “Healthy Relationships” approach, which focuses on identifying and promoting protective factors and establishing appropriate and healthy relationships.

Local sexual assault and domestic violence programs in Washington also have a significant focus on community education and prevention. It seeks to increase awareness and build the skills of community members to reduce risk factors and build protective factors against rape of a child and other forms of sexual abuse. Emergency shelter contractors funded through the state’s Family Violence Prevention Services Act and Victims of Crime Act grants are required to conduct prevention and community

education activities as well. Sexual assault services grantees, funded through Washington's Office of Crime Victims Advocacy, conduct sexual violence education and prevention with key stakeholders in local communities. Key targets for these efforts include those working in law enforcement, education and mental health counseling.

Educational offerings are designed to promote healthy, safe relationships, and address attitudes and beliefs related to a culture of perpetration and are often targeted at youth/teens.

(g) Implement policies and procedures as necessary to prevent access to assistance provided under the State program funded under this part through any electronic fund transaction in an automated teller machine or point-of-sale device located in a place described in section 408(a)(12), including a plan to ensure that recipients of the assistance have adequate access to their cash assistance (section 402(a)(1)(A)(vii) of the Social Security Act).

In 2011 the state legislature enacted RCW 74.08.580 to address concerns regarding use of benefits at prohibited establishments, specifically, the following activities and products:

- Gambling.
- Pari-mutuel betting.
- Lottery tickets.
- Tattoos.
- Body piercings.
- Tobacco products.
- Alcoholic beverages.

It further prohibits taverns, beer/wine specialty stores, nightclubs, contract liquor stores, bail bond agencies, gambling establishments, tattoo/body piercing shops, adult entertainment venues, or any establishment where persons under the age of eighteen are not permitted, from having Automated Teller Machines (ATMs) and Point of Sale (POS) terminals on their premises that accept EBT cards.

DSHS compares a list of EBT transactions at ATMs and POS machines monthly to a list of prohibited locations throughout the State provided by appropriate licensing authority for the state. The state Office of Fraud and Accountability or the state licensing authority for that business type (e.g. Liquor Control Board, Gaming Commission) physically inspects the location to verify that the match is accurate and appropriate and issues notices to non-compliant businesses and customers. Continued non-compliance by businesses results in referral to the individual licensing authority for regulatory action. Continued non-compliance by customers results in the opening of an intentional program violation investigation.

(h) Ensure that recipients of assistance provided under the State program funded under this part have the ability to use or withdraw assistance with minimal fees or charges, including an opportunity to access assistance with no fee or charges, and are provided information on applicable fees and surcharges that apply to electronic fund transactions involving the assistance, and that such information is made publicly available (section 402(a)(1)(A)(viii) of the Social Security Act).

Adequate authorized access to cash by recipients is ensured via an analysis required of the EBT vendor. The vendor is required by contract to perform a cash access assessment on an annual basis. The results

are reviewed with DSHS to address any drought identified, especially related to remote locations. If such a locale is identified during the annual review, the EBT vendor is prepared to deploy EBT-only point-of-sale (POS) machines that would allow cash transactions and cash-back access for those customers.

As of August 1, 2012, the EBT ATM fee imposed by Washington State's EBT vendor was eliminated. DSHS notifies customers that if they choose to withdraw cash benefits using an ATM, they may incur a surcharge for the transaction by the bank or ATM owner. Customers are encouraged to use POS terminals to avoid potential ATM surcharges. Retailers that accept EBT cards have the Quest mark decal that shows what benefits are accessible at each POS and ATM location. Customers can also log onto their online account and search for Chase ATMs or the customer can contact CSD to conduct a search of filtered retailers by ATM, POS, or both.

This information is provided on the form "Your DSHS Cash or Food Benefits" (DSHS 14-520), or the informational pamphlet "Your Washington EBT Quest Card" (DSHS 22-310), which is given over the counter in offices or mailed to customers. In May 2000, DSHS implemented Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT), allowing TANF families to have their cash assistance deposited if they have a new or current personal bank account. DSHS provides information to TANF families about EFT enrollment when they receive the EBT card.

(i) Indicate whether it intends to treat families moving from another State differently from other families under the program, and if so how (section 402(a)(1)(B)(i) of the Social Security Act).

Families from other states receive the same benefits as other longer term Washington state residents.

(j) Indicate whether it intends to provide assistance to non-citizens, and if so, include an overview of the assistance (section 402(a)(1)(B)(ii) of the Social Security Act).

Washington exercises its option to provide federally funded TANF, Medicaid, and social services block grant (SSBG) benefits to qualified non-citizen families who are eligible to receive these benefits. The State provides State Family Assistance which is state-funded cash and medical benefits to those individuals who do not qualify for federally funded assistance because of their immigration status, but otherwise meets all other eligibility requirements, including children and pregnant women. These are segregated funds and expenditures which are for the most part claimed toward the state's MOE requirement.

Washington follows federal sponsor deeming rules for relevant families receiving federally funded benefits. The income and resources of the sponsors for families receiving state-funded assistance are deemed until the sponsored immigrant becomes a naturalized U.S. citizen or has 40 work quarters under the Social Security Act. Sponsor liability does not apply to the victims of domestic violence who self-petitioned under the Violence Against Women Act and their dependents.

(k) Set forth objective criteria for the delivery of benefits and the determination of eligibility and for fair and equitable treatment, including an explanation of how it will provide opportunities for recipients who have been adversely affected to be heard in a State administrative or appeal process (section 402(a)(1)(B)(iii) of the Social Security Act).

The State provides customer protection by requiring that customers are:

- Treated with dignity and respect.
- Given sufficient opportunity to make their needs known to DSHS.
- Free from discrimination on any basis prohibited by state or federal law.
- Able to have eligibility determined according to rules and procedures of DSHS promulgated pursuant to the Administrative Procedures Act (RCW 34.05).
- Permitted to make applications for benefits and have the application processed and decision made in a timely manner.
- Informed of their rights and responsibilities.
- Informed of which programs and services are available to them through DSHS.
- Informed of the conditions, requirements and benefits for which they are eligible.
- Allowed to exercise, after full explanation, options and choices available to them.

Fair and equitable treatment does not mean that all WorkFirst services are available to all participants in all areas of the state at any one time. The State's need in some cases to gradually phase in a new service or to undertake pilot initiatives for purposes of determining program effectiveness may limit access to some services for some participants for limited periods of time.

Washington will ensure applicants and recipients of assistance are notified in writing of DSHS decisions regarding the type and amount of benefits available to them, including adequate and advance notice of adverse actions. The State will inform applicants and recipients of the legal basis for the determination and within 90 days of such notice they may request an administrative hearing, unless good cause is shown to have prevented submission of the request. If an applicant or recipient has good cause for the delay, they will be allowed to submit the request for up to one year after the aggrieving decision.

Washington will notify customers they may, without payment of a fee or posting a bond for filing such appeal or preparation of any necessary record, obtain judicial review of an adverse decision. The state will also explain the administrative hearing will be conducted by the independent Office of Administrative Hearings pursuant to state law (RCW 74.08, 34.05), with due process protections in place. The State provides an opportunity for any applicant or recipient aggrieved by an agency action to have an impartial administrative hearing before an Administrative Law Judge pursuant to RCW 74.08.080 and 34.05. The State will continue benefits pending the hearing decision, pursuant to Washington Administrative Code (WAC) 388-458-0040.

The TANF program has a statewide process for conducting application interviews for consistent administration of eligibility rules that include:

Household Composition (TANF/WorkFirst):

- Minor child(ren) 17 years or younger or child(ren) under age 19 who are making progress in High School (HS) or HS equivalency program.

- Pregnancy at any stage.
- Parents or related needy caregivers of specific degree (e.g. those caring for grandchildren, nieces/nephews).

Residency:

- Currently living in Washington state with no minimum time to establish residency.

Citizenship/Alien Status:

- U.S. Citizens.
- Qualified non-citizens, verified with use of Systematic Alien Verification for Entitlements (SAVE).

Social Security Number (SSN) Requirements:

- Supply or apply for SSN.
- Provide good cause for not applying/supplying.

Assignment of Child Support Rights:

- Cooperate with establishing child support.
- Provide good cause for non-cooperation.

Financial Eligibility for Aided Household Members:

- Countable earned income is based on household size and published in [WAC 388-478-0035](#).
- The unearned income limit is also the payment standard for cash assistance, [per WAC 388-478-0020](#).
- Countable Resource Limits
 - \$12,000 cash resource limit.
 - One vehicle of any value is excluded.

At or below 60 Month Time Limit for Recipients or:

- May meet Time Limit Extension criteria for aid after 60 months when -
 - Disabled and applying for SSI.
 - Caring for disabled adult or child.
 - Homeless.
 - Working 32 or more hours/week.
 - First time dependency with child welfare agency.
 - Addressing family violence.
 - Being actively on TANF during a period of statewide High Unemployment, defined as 7% or higher per [state regulation \(WAC 388-484-0006\)](#).
 - Caring for a child under the age of two.

Note – for this criteria, additional time on aid aligns with aided adult’s eligibility for Washington State’s infant/toddler participation exemption, or, subsequently, the postpartum participation exemption.

Other TANF programs:

- Kinship Care TANF:
 - Relatives of a specific degree defined in [WAC 388-454-0010](#).
 - Must cooperate with assignment of child support unless good cause claimed for non-cooperation.

- Any income to the child, including Title IV payments, is calculated when determining benefit level.
- Non-needy cases are not subject to income or resource limitations.
- Not subject to TANF 60-month time limit.
- In-Loco Parentis TANF:
 - Adults acting in place of parent without relation to specific degree with child, or without legal guardianship.
 - Must cooperate with child support assignment unless good cause claimed for non-cooperation.
 - Must authorize DSHS to perform a background check, which allows for provision of additional resource support, though results do not impact benefit eligibility.
 - These non-needy cases are not subject to income or resource limitations.
 - Any income to the child, including Title IV payments, is calculated when determining benefit level.
 - Not subject to TANF 60-month time limit.

The following must be included in the household receiving TANF:

- The child for whom benefits were requested on the application and the child's full, half or adopted siblings.
- The child's natural, adoptive parents, or stepparents.
- Pregnant minors and minor parents who live with parents who need assistance (may include other siblings).
- Pregnant individuals with no other dependent children residing with them.

For the purpose of receiving assistance, the following defines how many days a child may be absent from home in Washington state, and what are good cause exceptions:

- The State provides assistance for a minor child for 180 calendar days following the end of the month in which such child, parent, or other caretaker relative receiving assistance, leaves the home on a temporary basis.
- The State allows good cause exceptions to extend the child's period of absence from the customary family setting beyond 180 calendar days, including when the child, parent, or other caretaker relative is attending school pursuant to a plan approved by the department, and when the extension of time is beyond the control of the parent or other custodial relative receiving assistance.
- A parent or other caretaker relative must notify DSHS of an absence within the five calendar day period that begins on the date that it reasonably becomes clear to the parent or other caretaker relative that the absence will be for a period of greater than 180 days.

The income disregards for mandatory household members are:

- For applicants and recipients, DSHS only counts some of the income to determine eligibility and benefit level. The first \$500 is deducted from the total household's earned income, then 50% is subtracted from the remaining monthly gross earned income. This income disregard is applied to household members who are ineligible due to immigration status. The disregard also applies to working minors who are not currently enrolled or making progress in school. For working minors enrolled in school, we disregard 100% of their earned income.

- Only a portion of the income/resources of the parents of a minor parent is deemed as available, if the minor parent, living in the household, is applying for TANF with their own dependent child(ren). This includes the parents of a pregnant minor.
- All SSI income along with other income sources cited in [WAC 388-450-0015](#).
- The payment standard for the eligible household members is subtracted from the payment standard for a household that would include ineligible and disqualified members.
- After income is totaled, the difference between the two payment standards is subtracted and the following is deducted:
 - Legally-ordered child support
 - Employment-related child care expenses
- Whatever is left over, after deductions, is counted for the household.

(l) Indicate whether the State intends to assist individuals to train for, seek, and maintain employment (Section 402(a)(1)(B)(v) of the Social Security Act):

- *Providing direct care in a long-term care facility (as such terms are defined under section 1397j of this title),*
- *In other occupations related to elder care, high-demand occupations, or occupations expected to experience labor shortages as, determined appropriate by the State for which the State identifies an unmet need for service personnel, and, if so, shall include an overview of such assistance.*

Washington assists WorkFirst participants to receive training for or obtain employment in eldercare-related employment in the home, health, community care, and long-term care facilities when there are identified employment opportunities in local communities. The WorkFirst program seeks to balance meeting the needs of adults, based on their particular work histories, employment barriers, and personal goals, with the actual opportunities available to them on the job market. As indicated under (c) above, DSHS relies upon ESD to provide job market information and other employment services to its participants. SBCTC provides oversight of high-wage, high-demand education and training program approval and career pathway planning services to participants.

Washington State has opted out of the SSA 402(a)(1)(B)(iv) provision that a parent or caretaker receiving TANF assistance must perform community service employment if: they have received assistance for at least two months, they are not exempt from work requirements, and they are not currently engaged in work.

(m) Provide for all MOE-funded services the following information: the name of the program benefit or service, and the financial eligibility criteria that families must meet in order to receive that benefit or service. In addition, for TANF MOE-funded services (co-mingled or segregated MOE) describe the program benefit provided to eligible families (SSP services do not have to include a description, but the Department of Health and Human Services encourages it) (§263.2(b)(3) & §263.2(c) preamble pages 17826-7).

Through a variety of state and community-based service providers, the State offers the following types of services which meet one, or more, of the four TANF purposes. Services provided to families (and qualifying non-custodial parents) whose income is at or below 400% of the (FPL) include:

- Financial literacy.
- Classes in child development, community resources, and parenting skills.
- One-to-one mentoring of children and youth in professionally supported relationships.
- Individual, marital, and family counseling services, to include domestic violence counseling for victims and offenders.
- Alternative secondary education for at-risk youth that provides education, clinical counseling, and social services to students and families who have social adjustment, emotional, or school-related difficulties.
- Community centers that provide family support and family preservation services.
- Domestic abuse shelters that provide victims of domestic violence and their families with a safe haven of temporary shelter with provisions for basic needs (food, clothing, etc.), counseling, and services for children.
- Housing for eligible victims who need safety and support and are ready to go to school/work.
- Preschool programs for 3- and 4-year-old children provided at no cost to income eligible children.
- Medical services and financial benefits to noncustodial needy family members to address work-related injuries.
- Domestic violence services such as assessment service, planning, counseling services, case management, and linkage and referral to recipients of TANF who have or are currently experiencing issues of safety and functioning related to domestic violence, which would adversely affect their ability to become self-sufficient.
- After school programs for children.
- Food, meals, groceries, and volunteer services at food and commodity outlets and soup kitchens.
- Services and education activities to prepare for employment.
- Residential shelter and outreach to eligible teens.
- One-time financial and material assistance to eligible families, including but not limited to Washington's Working Families Tax Credit.
- Education and enrichment programs to children of all ages.
- Youth development programs.
- Programs that address social-economic barriers, family violence, lack of workplace skills, poverty, teenage pregnancy, poor school performance, and behavioral difficulties.
- Programs that provide public awareness, education, and advocacy to prevent child abuse and neglect in families.
- Drug and alcohol treatment.
- Subsidized and unsubsidized work experience.